ENGLISH LAB · READING CORNER

Maya Live!

A mystery at the skate park



Core · A2

2 ESO · Free Time, Live! · LS2
Six chapters · one a week

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How to read this book

Read one chapter a week at home, with the Learning Path it goes with. Read it once for the story, then again more slowly.

The words in the box at the start help you. They are underlined in the story.

At the end of each chapter, circle one answer to each question. In class we talk about the chapter for ten minutes and see who guessed what happens next.

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CHAPTER 1

Look behind you

Read it with Learning Path 1

WORDS TO HELP YOU

alarm = *despertador*
behind = *darrere*
box = *capsa*
steady = *ferm*
mystery = *misteri*

It's Saturday morning and Maya's alarm is making a terrible noise. She gets up at eight, switches it off and puts on her favourite tracksuit. Teo, her little brother, is already playing video games. "You're late," Teo says without looking away from the screen. "It's Saturday! I'm not late for anything."

Maya is thirteen. She loves skating and has got a channel called Maya Live! with 46 subscribers. Every weekend she records a video, and on Sunday she uploads it.

Her best friend Sami takes the photos. He doesn't skate, but he has got a very steady hand with a camera. At the skate park, the weather is cold and windy. Maya puts on her helmet.

"Ready?" Sami asks.

"Always. And no videos of me falling, please."

"I can't promise that."

Maya starts skating. Sami is recording. "Hi, everyone! Welcome to my vlog! Today I'm skating with Sami. Well, I'm skating. He's standing there and laughing!"

Sami waves at the camera.

The wind almost takes his cap. On Sunday evening, Maya finishes her homework and uploads the video. Her phone makes a sound: a new comment from Fox_13. "Great video! But look behind you at 2:14."

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"Teo! Is that you?" Maya asks.

"No. I only comment on videos about cats."

Maya plays the video again and stops at 2:14. Behind her, under a big tree, there is a person in a black helmet and an orange cap.

The person is putting a small green box under the tree, then looking straight at the camera and running away. Maya sends the video to Sami. He replies straight away: "That's not me. Who is Fox_13?" Maya types, "I don't know." Then Sami sends one more message: "More important: what's in that box?"

THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND?

What does Maya see behind her in the video?

- (A) A person putting a box under a tree
- (B) A dog riding a bike
- (C) Teo playing football

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS!

What is inside the green box?

- (A) A mobile phone
- (B) An orange T-shirt and a card
- (C) A bicycle helmet

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CHAPTER 2

The box

Read it with Learning Path 2

WORDS TO HELP YOU

bench = *banc*
umbrella = *paraigua*
scarf = *bufanda*
stalls = *parades*
clever = *espavilat*

On Monday after school, Maya and Sami go back to the skate park. It's raining and very cold. Sami is wearing boots and holding a huge umbrella. "Are we looking for a box or going swimming?" he asks.

"Stop talking and look for the tree!"

They find the green box under the big tree, next to a bench. It's wet, but the card inside is dry. There is also an orange T-shirt. The card says: "BROOKFIELD AUTUMN FUN RUN. Sunday, 10:00. Wear this T-shirt. Look for the fox."

"A fun run?" Maya says.

"Running is not fun. Skating is fun."

"You love mysteries," Sami says. "And this is a mystery with free clothes."

All week Maya checks her channel, but Fox_13 doesn't write another comment. She thinks about the box in class and at dinner. Even Teo notices. "You're looking at that T-shirt again. Is it famous?"

"Not yet."

On Saturday, Maya and Sami practise running at the park.

After twenty minutes, Maya is sitting on a bench, drinking water. "I can skate for an hour," she says, "but running is terrible!"

"You're doing great," Sami says. "For a person who hates running."

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On Sunday morning the park is foggy and freezing. Maya is wearing the orange T-shirt over her tracksuit. Sami has got a scarf and a hat. There are hundreds of people, loud music and food stalls. A little dog is even wearing a small orange shirt. Then Maya stops walking. "Sami. Look around."

Everyone is wearing orange: the runners, the helpers, the children and their parents.

"That's clever," Sami says. "Fox_13 knows we can't find one orange T-shirt in this crowd."

"Maybe we can look for a black helmet," Maya says.

"On a running day? Good idea." Before she can answer, someone behind her says, "Hi, Maya. Nice T-shirt."

Maya turns around.

THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND?

What does the card ask Maya to do?

(A) Go to the Fun Run in an orange T-shirt

(B) Buy a new skateboard

(C) Take Teo to school

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS!

Who says "Nice T-shirt" at the race?

(A) Leo Fox

(B) Maya's mum

(C) Kate, the organiser

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CHAPTER 3

Not today

Read it with Learning Path 3

WORDS TO HELP YOU

clipboard = *carpeta amb pinça*
finish line = *línia d'arribada*
helpers = *ajudants*
thick = *espessa*
apparently = *pel que sembla*

Maya turns around, ready to shout, "Fox_13!" But the person behind her isn't wearing a helmet. It's a tall woman with a small board and a pen. "Hi, Maya! I'm Kate. I organise the Fun Run. Can you help at the water table?"

"How do you know my name?" Maya asks.

"It's on your T-shirt. Look, next to the little fox."

Maya looks down. She's right. Sami laughs. "So we're not running?" he asks.

"No," Kate says. "We need helpers, not runners."

"This is my favourite race," Maya says.

Now Maya and Sami are giving water to the runners. A man in a banana costume takes a cup. A girl asks for two: one for her and one for her dog.

"Does the dog like running?" Sami asks.

"More than Maya!" the girl says.

Maya is usually at the skate park on Sunday mornings. Today she's at a water table. She takes out her phone and records a short vlog. "Hi, everyone! Today I'm at the Brookfield Fun Run. People are running, the crowd is cheering, and I'm giving out water. Sami is taking photos. We're not skating today!"

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A minute later Sami stops. He's looking past the runners. "Maya. At the finish line. Look at that bike."

A person is recording the race. The person is wearing a black helmet and an orange cap.

"Fox_13!" Maya says. "Come on!"

They run towards the finish line, but the fog is thick and the crowd is big.

When they get there, the person and the bike are gone.

"That is not fair," Maya says, trying to see through the fog.

"Look down," Sami says.

There is a card on the ground. Maya picks it up and reads: "Good job, helpers! Next clue: check my channel."

"Fox_13 has got a channel?" Sami asks.

"Apparently," says Maya. "Let's check it tonight. And let's check the right one."

THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND?

What are Maya and Sami doing at the Fun Run?

- (A) Selling trainers
- (B) Giving water to runners
- (C) Playing video games

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS!

What important clue do they find on Fox_13's channel?

- (A) A blue bag with the BHS school logo
- (B) A letter from Australia
- (C) A photo of Maya's mum

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CHAPTER 4

Can you trust it?

Read it with Learning Path 4

WORDS TO HELP YOU

author = *autor*
logo = *logotip*
source = *font*
rider = *ciclista*
credits = *crèdits*

On Sunday evening, Maya and Sami are sitting at Maya's kitchen table. Her laptop is open and Teo is watching over their shoulders.

"Let's search for Fox_13," Sami says.

"Wait," Maya replies. "First we check the source. Who is the author? What's the date? Can we trust the page?"

"You sound exactly like our teacher," Sami says. "Thank you. I think."

They find a website about wild foxes. It has beautiful photos but no author and no date.

"Great animals, wrong fox," Maya says.

Next, they find a gaming channel. The user is called Fox_13, but the last video is from 2019 and the person lives in Australia.

"Our mystery person hasn't got a very fast bike, so that's not our fox," Sami says.

Then they discover a small channel called Fox_13: Brookfield Bikes. It has got three subscribers and five videos. The latest video is from today's Fun Run.

"That's the black helmet!" Maya says. They watch the other videos.

The rider is filming at the bike park, but never shows a face. The last screen gives music and video credits.

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"Good credits," Sami says. "At least this person knows how to credit a source."

"I just want to know the name," Maya replies.

Teo is eating an apple. Suddenly he points at the screen. "Go back! Look at that blue bag!"

In one video there's a school bag next to the bike. The logo shows a green tree and the letters BHS.

"Brookfield High School," Maya says quietly. "That's our school."

"So Fox_13 is a student here," Sami says. "This is getting strange."

Just then, the channel has got a new video. They click on it. There's no music, no bike and no face. The screen is black, with three short lines in white: "TOMORROW. ROOM 13. BREAK TIME." Sami looks at Maya. "Do you know where Room 13 is?"

Maya closes the laptop. "Yes. And now I can't stop thinking about it."

THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND?

Why is the Brookfield Bikes channel the right one?

- (A) It has millions of subscribers
- (B) It shows today's Fun Run and the black helmet
- (C) It is a channel about wild animals

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS!

Who is Fox_13?

- (A) Kate
- (B) Teo
- (C) Leo, the new student

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CHAPTER 5

Room 13

Read it with Learning Path 5

WORDS TO HELP YOU

midnight = *mitjanit*
strangers = *desconeguts*
aunt = *tieta*
whisper = *xiuxiuejar*
puzzles = *trencaclosques*

It's midnight. Maya is in bed, but she isn't sleeping. She's watching Fox_13's videos for the fourth time. Her mum opens the door. "Maya! Switch off your phone. Don't use it in bed. Put it on your desk and get some sleep."

"Just five minutes?"

"You say that every five minutes."

The next morning Maya is tired. She doesn't feel like breakfast and can't concentrate in class. At break time she meets Sami by Room 13. "Ready?" Sami asks.

"I think so. You go first."

"It's your mystery!"

Room 13 is the school library. There are books, tables and one boy in a quiet corner. He's reading a comic. His name is Leo. He's new at Brookfield High School and usually eats lunch alone. On the table next to him there is a black helmet and an orange cap. Sami whispers, "Well, that's not very difficult to see."

Maya walks over. "Hi, Leo. Are you Fox_13?"

Leo looks up. His face goes red. "Yes. Sorry. I love your videos, Maya."

"Why all the clues?" Maya asks.

"And why are you wearing the helmet in every video?"

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Leo puts down his comic. “I’m new here. I don’t know many people, and I hate talking to strangers. But I love making games and puzzles. This is my way of saying hello.”

“It’s a very long hello,” Sami says.

Then he smiles. “But it’s a good game.”

“And Kate at the Fun Run?” Maya asks.

“She’s my aunt. She helps me with the T-shirt.”

Maya sits next to Leo. “Well, you can say hello without a helmet now. Do you like skating?”

“I prefer cycling. But I’m good at filming.”

“Perfect,” says Sami.

“Our team has got a new camera person.” Leo laughs for the first time.

Then he takes another small green box out of his bag. “Before we do anything else,” he says, “here’s the last clue.”

THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND?

Why does Leo create the mystery game?

- (A) He wants to make friends but feels shy
- (B) He wants to win a race
- (C) He wants to take Maya’s phone

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS!

What is the final green-box clue for?

- (A) A football match
- (B) Making a vlog together
- (C) Another running race

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CHAPTER 6

Maya Live! with friends

Read it with Learning Path 6

WORDS TO HELP YOU

ramps = *rampes*
greeting = *salutació*
dramatic = *dramàtic*
stare = *quedar-se mirant*
owl = *mussol*

Leo opens the last green box. There's only a card inside: "Saturday, 11:00. Bike park. Bring your camera."

"A new mystery?" Maya asks.

Leo shakes his head. "No. This time I just want to make a video with you."

On Saturday the three friends meet at the bike park. It's sunny and cold, but not windy. Maya is wearing her helmet and tracksuit. Leo has got his bike, and Sami is ready with his camera.

"Before we start," Maya says, "we need a plan. Good videos don't just happen."

Leo opens his notebook. "First a greeting. Then your skating, my cycling and Sami's photos. After that we can talk about what we like doing. And we need a screen tip."

"Can we add a scene with me falling?" Sami asks.

"You don't even skate," Maya says.

"Exactly. Very dramatic." They laugh and start recording. "Hi, everyone! Welcome to Maya Live! Today I'm at the bike park with my friend Sami and a new friend, Leo Fox. Yes, he's Fox_13!"

Leo waves. He's usually shy, but today he's smiling at the camera. "Right now Leo is riding his bike. I'm trying to skate on these ramps. I usually go skating at the skate park, so this is difficult for me!"

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Sami takes photos while Maya and Leo practise. Then they sit together for the final part.

"We love making videos," Leo says, "but real life is important too. Put your phone away sometimes. Take a break and go outside."

"And meet your friends," Maya adds.

On Sunday evening Maya uploads their new vlog. It's her favourite video. The channel now has 120 subscribers. Ten minutes later a comment appears. It isn't from Fox_13. It's from Owl_7. "Great video! But look behind you at 3:05…"

Maya stares at the screen. "Sami," she says, "please tell me this is your joke."

THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND?

What screen tip does Leo give?

A Watch videos all night

B Buy a bigger phone

C Put your phone away and go outside

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS!

What will Maya most likely check first in the next story?

A The video at 3:05

B A new pair of trainers

C Her Maths homework

✦ ✦ ✦

To be continued…

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